

7.1 Internal Hard drives

► **Problem:** You can't access the full capacity of a hard drive that's larger than 8.4 GB.

Cause: This is a common problem with older computers when the hard drive is upgraded. BIOSes on older machines were written such that they could only recognise hard drives of up to 8 GB capacity. When one tries to attach a higher-capacity hard drive, the system either recognises it as an 8 GB drive, or fails to recognise it altogether.

Solution: The most common solution to this problem is to flash the motherboard BIOS. However, since such motherboards are really dated, it is quite unlikely that you'll be able to get hold of new BIOS. If you're lucky, you might find a



new BIOS on the manufacturer's Web site. If you don't, you have the option of installing an IDE-PCI card—a card that fits into the PCI slot and offers two IDE connectors for hard drives. These IDE-PCI cards have a separate BIOS, which allows you to attach higher-capacity hard drives. It shouldn't cost more than Rs 500.

► **Problem:** FDISK in Windows 98 misidentifies the capacity of a drive over 64 GB.

Cause: This generally occurs when your bootable floppy has an older version of the FDISK tool.

Solution: FDISK is a hard drive partitioning tool often used for preparing the hard drive before installing an OS. This tool is often bundled with the Windows CD, and is an essential part of the bootable floppy created using any Windows machine. If you have your original Windows 98 CD then boot the machine via it and then use the FDISK tool from the CD. Else you can also use the Ranish Par-